

Diana Payton

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Technical Documentation Leader

Strategic Documentation Manager with 15+ years of experience specializing in "Zero-to-One" documentation functions. Expert in transforming fragmented tribal knowledge into scalable Docs-Like-Code infrastructures that align with modern engineering sprints. Proven leader in building documentation teams from scratch, fixing broken user experiences, and bridging the gap between engineering complexity and user success.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

- **Documentation systems:** Docs-Like-Code, Docusaurus, Mintlify, Hugo, Sphinx, MadCap Flare, Git/GitHub/GitLab, Markdown, RST, XML
- **Languages and frameworks:** Python, JavaScript, SQL, JQuery, HTML/CSS, OpenAPI/Swagger
- **Specialized domains:** Information architecture, content strategy, Machine learning (ML) models, Cybersecurity, API/SDK documentation and testing, CLI documentation and testing
- **Project Management:** Jira, Linear, Agile/Scrum, Documentation strategy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HACKMAMBA | Technical Documentation Manager | Remote | Jan 2025 – Present

- **Strategic consulting:** Partner with client companies to audit internal processes and design bespoke documentation plans that align with aggressive business growth goals.
- **Workflow architecture:** Design and implement processes tailored to the specific technical stacks and release cycles of diverse development teams.
- **Leadership and quality:** Manage and coach embedded writers, providing high-level editorial oversight and mentorship to ensure technical accuracy and consistency.

MACROMETA | Technical Writing Manager | Remote | May 2022 – May 2024

- **Culture transformation:** Acted as the primary advocate for a company-wide "documentation culture," securing stakeholder buy-in for new standardized procedures.
- **System modernization:** Led a cross-functional team to overhaul legacy content, managed it to a structured Docusaurus site built using Git and Markdown.
- **Technical integration:** Collaborated directly with SMEs to write and validate complex documentation for global data networks; tested and updated CLI, API, and SDK code samples.
- **Standardization:** Established a documentation handbook in Notion to standardize onboarding and ensure consistent contributions from cross-functional documentarians.

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LAYER | Technical Documentation Manager (First Technical Writer) | Remote | Aug 2021 – Apr 2022

- **Zero-to-one infrastructure:** Established the company's first formal documentation processes, moving away from fragmented tribal knowledge to a structured, user-centric strategy.
- **Deep technical literacy:** Self-taught Machine Learning proficiency to write, test, and validate complex ML-focused SDKs and CLI tools via Jupyter and Colab notebooks.
- **Cultural leadership:** Acted as a Documentation Evangelist, educating engineering teams on documentation value-add and best practices for collaborative authoring in a monorepo environment.
- **System architecture:** Designed and implemented agile documentation workflows parallel to rapid software development cycles, ensuring docs kept pace with product velocity.

GRAFANA LABS | Technical Documentation Lead | Remote | Nov 2019 – Jul 2021

- **Strategic transformation:** Led a team of senior writers to reorganize documentation architecture, transforming a set with "huge gaps" into a high-utility community resource.
- **Product ownership:** Voluntarily managed the Grafana Playground; rehabilitated disorganized and broken dashboards to ensure a high-quality "first look" for potential enterprise customers.
- **Team scaling and hiring:** Directed the hiring and training of new technical writers; managed the strategic expansion of documentation for Loki, Tempo, and Grafana Cloud.
- **Community engagement:** Streamlined the open-source contribution process and authored a comprehensive style guide to improve Git/Markdown contributions.

THERMO FISHER SCIENTIFIC | Technical Publications Manager | Hillsboro, OR | Apr 2017 – Nov 2019

- **Change management:** Overhauled high-risk documentation processes, successfully migrating the site from legacy PDF-based editing to a modern Docs-Like-Code workflow using Git.
- **Operational efficiency:** Engineered a 40–50% gain in document processing speed by implementing MadCap Flare templates, variables, and single-sourcing.
- **Stakeholder alignment:** Negotiated and enforced a roadmap policy for doc requests, improving content accuracy through mandated SME approval cycles.
- **Technical contributions:** Partnered with developers to write, edit, and test internal API documentation and improve Swagger/OpenAPI resources.

CLINICIENT | Senior Technical Writer (First Senior Hire) | Portland, OR | June 2016 – Jan 2017

- **Relationship rehabilitation:** Re-established critical inter-departmental trust and became a key contributor in engineering standups and escalation meetings to identify documentation gaps.
- **UX/UI optimization:** Debugged and refactored help-site CSS and integrated support-driven feedback loops to craft a reliable release documentation process.

DSV | Senior Technical Writer / Team Lead | Portland, OR | Nov 2012 – June 2016

- **Department reconstruction:** Following a total department turnover, took accountability for rebuilding the writing team from the ground up, including all hiring and mentorship.
- **Process modernization:** Led the conversion of legacy documentation into single-sourced MadCap Flare projects and introduced video-based demonstrations using Camtasia.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Writer | Columbia Helicopters, Columbia Ultimate, RadiSys | 2008 – 2012

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (M.A.) in Writing (Professional and Technical Writing) | Portland State University

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Graphic Communications & Studio Art | Eastern Washington University